

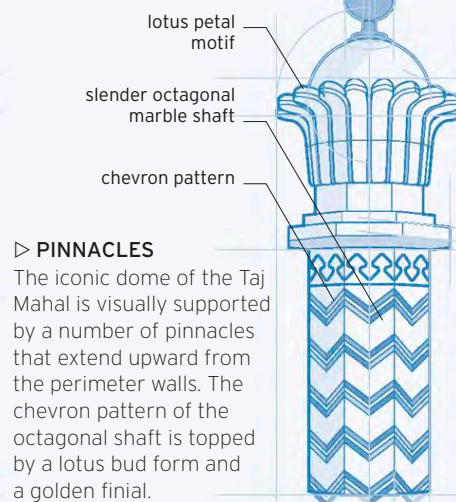
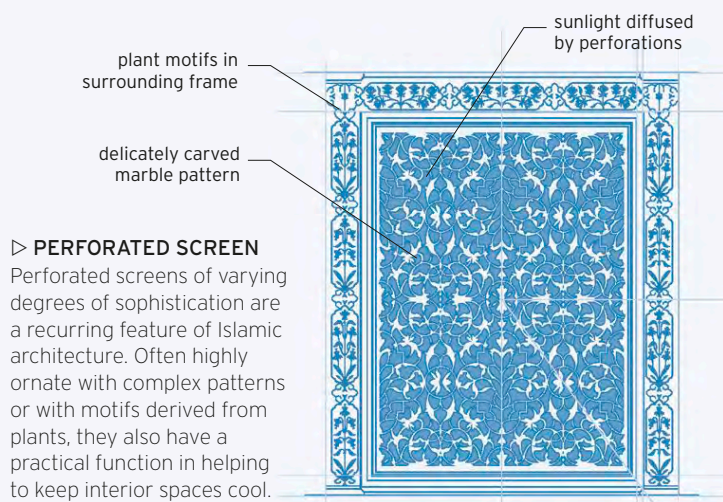
Architectural styles

LATER ISLAMIC

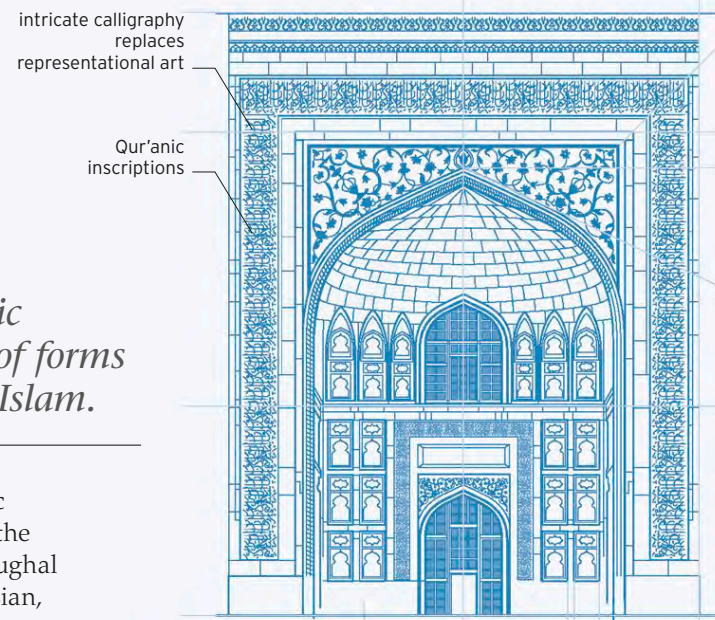
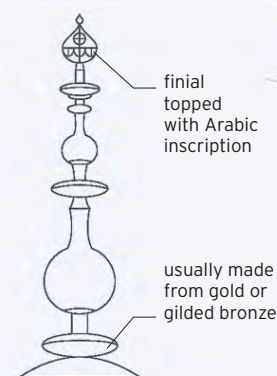
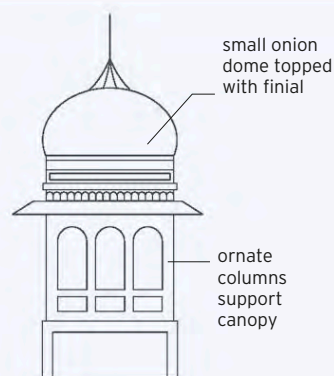
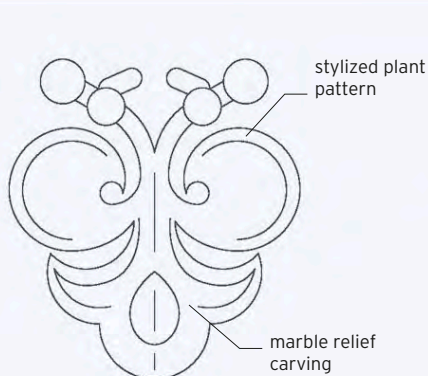
Even as it has assimilated other styles and traditions, Islamic architecture remains closely tied to a distinctive vocabulary of forms and decoration informed by the traditions and principles of Islam.

As Islam spread from the Middle East throughout the world, new variations of Islamic architecture emerged, influenced by local traditions. One of the most distinctive was the Mughal empire's architecture. At its height during the 17th and 18th centuries, the Mughal empire controlled much of the Indian subcontinent. Architecturally, it drew from Persian, Indian, and Islamic traditions and is marked out by its use of large onion domes, impressive gateways, slender towers, and delicate ornamentation. The style was arguably at its apex under Shah Jahan, who built the Jama Masjid mosque in Delhi; the Shalimar Gardens in Lahore; and Mughal architecture's most famous building, the Taj Mahal.

Today, Islamic architecture continues to incorporate new forms and technologies while remaining closely informed by the style's rich traditions, heritage, and underlying basis in the Islamic faith.



ARCHITECTURAL EMBELLISHMENTS



all four minarets are ornamental

each minaret is 137 ft (42 m) high

plinth raises building above ground level

square plinth with minaret in each corner

▲ **TAJ MAHAL**

The Taj Mahal (see pp.290-291) was built in the mid-17th century by Shah Jahan as a tomb for his favorite wife, Mumtaz Mahal. Constructed from white marble and richly ornamented, the tomb is at the center of a complex also containing a mosque and long reflecting pool.